Satya Nadella

Microsoft | Chairman and CEO, since 2014

Meeting: First intro: earn a second meeting | Prepared for: Founder / principal | Depth: standard | Sources: 8 of 12 source types, 18 cited | Status LIMITED | Prepared Oct 16, 2026

Take. Satya Nadella, Microsoft's Chairman and CEO [1], names knowledge work a focus [2]; 30 million paid Copilot seats [3] are a fraction of 450 million workers [4]. **Evidence:** [2] [3] [4]. **Action:** open on adoption past 30 million seats [3]. **Avoid:** spend-led pitches; he calls CapEx talk "a bug" [5].

QUESTIONS THAT CLOSE GAPS

1. **Autopilot handles recurring work and follow-ups** [6]**; which meeting tasks does it skip?**
   Decides: whether a prep gap exists. **Ask:** Satya Nadella.
2. **Jared Spataro wrote the Copilot launch post** [7]**; who owns executive use?**
   Decides: the owner for meeting two. **Ask:** Satya Nadella.
3. **You build "long-running Foundry agents"** [8]**; which serve executives' own meetings?**
   Decides: fit with his agent plans. **Ask:** Satya Nadella.
4. **How does "Use all, but be independent of all"** [9] **apply to small tools?**
   Decides: partner or build stance. **Ask:** Satya Nadella.
5. **After April's buyouts** [10]**, what must a tool prove to earn an executive team's time?**
   Decides: the gate. **Ask:** Satya Nadella.

WHO THEY ARE

- **Role:** Chairman and CEO; named CEO in February 2014 [11].
- **Path:** led the Cloud and Enterprise group [12].
- **The organization:** mission: empower every person and organization to achieve more [13].
- **What changed:** new Copilot with Autopilot (Sep 25) [14]; buyouts for about 7% of US staff (Apr 23) [10]
- **Recent wins:** Azure up 43%, past $100 billion (Jul 29, 2026) [15]

IN THEIR WORDS

- **On Microsoft's role, All-In, Sep 15, 2026:** "We're a toolmaker." [16]
- **On focus, Stratechery, Jun 4, 2026:** "three domains ... coding, security, and knowledge work" [2]

LinkedIn: not read: no matching profile

SIGNALS AND WHAT TO DO WITH THEM

OBSERVABLE	WHAT TO DO WITH IT
Copilot has about 30 million users against 450 million knowledge workers [4]	Adoption is the open gap; any route to daily executive use matters.
Your offer is meeting prep for executive teams [17]	Executives walk into every meeting prepared, with no setup.
Results are due October 28, after the market closes [18]	His attention is on adoption numbers; context, never pressure.

BEHAVIORAL PROFILE

WHAT THE RECORD SHOWS	YOUR MOVE
Pace and control: names his three focus domains himself [2]	Match their pace; propose once, then ask.
Appetite for detail: cites seat counts and market size [3] [4]	Headline, two proof points, a source on request.
Appetite for risk: "independent of all" while building [9]	Pair the upside with the safeguard in the same sentence.

No read: How they take recognition · How they take disagreement · How they keep score

Evidence tier: medium: it sets how far page 3 goes

WHO DECIDES

- **Decision maker:** Not determined
- **The gate:** Not determined
- **Relationship holder:** Not determined

STRONGEST CASE AGAINST

- **Against:** Autopilot already covers recurring work [6]. **Reverses if:** Nadella's team names a prep gap.
- **Against:** April's buyouts [10] signal cost scrutiny. **Reverses if:** Microsoft's team counts the hours saved.

MEETING ANGLE

A. This meeting

- **Frame:** how his executives prepare; no pitch.
- **Lands:** "independent of all" [9]: be replaceable.
- **Repels:** spend-led pitches [5].
- **What to bring:** a one-page example [17].
- **The ask:** 30 minutes with him or his owner [17] · **Fallback:** 15 minutes with Spataro [7].
- **Stop if:** he says Copilot covers it.

B. Meeting two

- **Meeting two:** a session on seats past 30 million [3].
- **Meeting three:** a pilot with one executive team.

C. After the meeting

- **Capture:** who owns it; what Copilot leaves out.

EVIDENCE LEDGER

18 facts cited; status LIMITED at 8 of 12 source types. Strength: Strong: primary, dated · Solid: reputable secondary · Weak: single source · Inferred: no source states it. Dates: the source's own; 'seen' = the day it was read.

#	WHAT IT SAYS	SOURCE	GRADE	DATE
[1]	Chairman and CEO of Microsoft	news.microsoft.com · Direct	Measured · Strong	seen Oct 16, 2026
[2]	Focus: coding, security, work	stratechery.com · Direct	Measured · Solid	Jun 4, 2026
[3]	Copilot passed 30M paid seats	microsoft.com · Direct	Measured · Strong	Jul 29, 2026
[4]	30M users, 450M workers	thefabulous.co · Direct	Measured · Weak	Sep 15, 2026
[5]	Quote: CapEx talk is "a bug"	thefabulous.co · Direct	Measured · Weak	Sep 15, 2026
[6]	Autopilot: recurring tasks	blogs.microsoft.com · Direct	Measured · Strong	Sep 25, 2026
[7]	Spataro wrote the launch post	blogs.microsoft.com · Direct	Measured · Strong	Sep 25, 2026
[8]	Quote: "Foundry agents"	latent.space · Direct	Measured · Solid	Jun 3, 2026
[9]	Quote: "independent of all"	thefabulous.co · Direct	Measured · Weak	Sep 15, 2026
[10]	Buyouts: about 7% of staff	news.bloomberglaw.com · Direct	Measured · Solid	Apr 23, 2026
[11]	Named CEO in February 2014	news.microsoft.com · Direct	Measured · Strong	Feb 4, 2014
[12]	Led Cloud and Enterprise	news.microsoft.com · Direct	Measured · Strong	Feb 4, 2014
[13]	Mission: empower every person	microsoft.com · Direct	Measured · Strong	seen Oct 16, 2026
[14]	New Copilot with Autopilot	blogs.microsoft.com · Direct	Measured · Strong	Sep 25, 2026
[15]	Azure up 43%, over $100B	microsoft.com · Direct	Measured · Strong	Jul 29, 2026
[16]	Quote: "We're a toolmaker."	thefabulous.co · Direct	Measured · Weak	Sep 15, 2026
[17]	Talyx offer: meeting prep	your saved setup · Yours	Measured · Weak	seen Oct 16, 2026
[18]	Q1 results Oct 28, after close	news.microsoft.com · Direct	Measured · Strong	Oct 7, 2026

Coverage	8 of 12 source types in the base pass · rounds 5 of 5 · Not found: public social, affiliations, publications, registers · LinkedIn: not read: no matching profile
Still open	• Decision maker: Who owns executive meeting prep? • The gate: What must a tool prove first? • Relationship holder: Who vets outside tools? • How they take disagreement: How should pushback be raised?
Left out on purpose	health, family, politics, litigation, personal finances
Run	Oct 16, 2026 · standard · first intro · founder / principal · general professional · US · LIMITED · 6.0 decision-useful facts per page · 30 searches (10 base) in 5 rounds

MEETING SCRIPT

Facts choose the moves; read the room, not the record · Satya Nadella, Microsoft · Prepared Oct 16, 2026

1. OPEN

- **Hook:** *Congratulations on 30 million paid Copilot seats [3]. You named knowledge work a domain to major on [2], so I have one question about it.*
- **Credibility:** Talyx builds AI meeting-prep tools for executive teams [17].
- **Insight:** Autopilot covers follow-ups [6]; preparing before the meeting is not in its description.
- **Rule:** ask one question, then stop; leave the silence after his answer.

2. QUESTION ORDER

- **Beats:** open on the seat count [3]
- **Beats:** credibility in one line [17]
- **Beats:** the insight on Autopilot [6]
- **Beats:** ask for the second meeting [17]
- **Story:** You build "long-running Foundry agents" [8]; which serve executives' own meetings?
- **Process:** Jared Spataro wrote the Copilot launch post [7]; who owns executive use?
- **Gate:** After April's buyouts [10], what must a tool prove to earn an executive team's time?
- **History:** How does "Use all, but be independent of all" [9] apply to small tools?
- **Commitment:** Autopilot handles recurring work and follow-ups [6]; which meeting tasks does it skip?

3. OBJECTIONS: NAME IT, THEN ANSWER

- **"Copilot already does this.":** *Autopilot covers follow-ups [6]; which meeting tasks does it skip?*
- **"No time for another vendor.":** *April's buyouts [10] show cost care; I ask for 30 minutes, nothing more.*
- **"We build, we do not buy.":** *You said "Use all, but be independent of all" [9]; I am replaceable.*

4. CLOSE

- **Restate:** ask what would make 30 more minutes an easy yes, then say it back in his words.
- **Real deadline:** his October 28 results [18] are the next fixed point; offer a slot after it.
- **The ask:** 30 minutes with him or his owner [17] · **Fallback:** 15 minutes with Spataro [7].
- **Follow-up:** send the one-page example within one day.

5. READ THE ROOM (WATCH, DO NOT ASSUME)

- **Fast, wants the answer:** match his pace; propose once, then ask [2].
- **Asks for terms and data:** headline, two proof points, a source on request [3].
- **Talks about people:** no read; ask who else weighs in.
- **Big picture, ideas:** pair the upside with the safeguard [9].

6. IF IT STALLS

- **The move:** ask which Autopilot gap matters most [6]
- **The move:** return to 30 million seats against 450 million workers [4]

7. GUARDRAILS

- **Rule:** in the US, promise no results from Microsoft's products; claim only what the public record shows.
- **Never say:** "Does that make sense?" · "Is this helpful?" · "No pressure" · "You'd know better than me" · "Just checking in"

Next step: send the one-page example on Oct 17, 2026 [17].